

[ENTER COMPANY NAME]

QUALITY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

# STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Product Recall and Field Safety Corrective Actions

|                                 |                                                                                                                   |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
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| Review Cycle                    | Annual (Every 12 Months)                                                                                          |
| Applicable Regulatory Standards | ISO 13485:2016 Clause 8.5.1 & 8.5.2<br>FDA 21 CFR Part 7 & Part 806<br>EU MDR 2017/745 Articles 89 & 90 [cite: 9] |

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| <b>Date:</b> _____                                       | <b>Date:</b> _____                                            | <b>Date:</b> _____                                                           |

## 1.0 Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) defines the mandatory execution steps, internal mobilization workflows, and health authority communication pathways required to locate, quarantine, remove, or modify noncompliant, defective, or hazardous medical devices that have escaped into commercial distribution channels. The main focus is to systematically contain public health exposure, retrieve volatile distributed lots, and satisfy strict enforcement timelines dictated by regional regulatory frameworks.

## 2.0 Scope

This procedure is activated whenever clinical field data, manufacturing nonconformities, stability testing failures, or regulatory authority directives indicate that a distributed medical device family does not fully conform to approved safety, performance, or label criteria. This SOP governs all Field Safety Corrective Actions (FSCA), customer stock recovery steps, remote electronic software modifications, and physical product recalls.

## 3.0 Responsibility and Authority

### 3.1 Field Action Executive Committee (FAEC)

A corporate crisis committee mobilized immediately during product escapes, composed of the Head of Quality Operations, VP of Regulatory Affairs, Chief Legal Counsel, and the Director of Logistics.

### 3.2 Recall Coordinator

A designated Quality Specialist holding responsibility to track customer return logistics, maintain the recall master ledger, manage reconciliation accounts, and compile ongoing progress cards for external auditing panels.

### 3.3 Executive Management / PRRC

Holds absolute authority to execute the final field action activation mandate, authorize global distribution sweeps, and sign off on formal Field Safety Notices (FSN) sent to institutional users.

## 4.0 Procedure

### 4.1 Field Action Triage and Risk Mitigation Classes

Upon receiving a potential lot escape alert from the complaint or manufacturing modules, the FAEC must immediately execute a Health Hazard Assessment (HHA). This assessment determines the depth and class of the field action required by measuring real-world patient safety risks against regulatory classifications:

| Recall Classification           | Health Hazard Definition and Patient Impact Parameters                                                                                                                                                 | Statutory Notification Timelines                                          |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Class I (Critical Risk)</b>  | A critical situation where there is a reasonable probability that using or exposure to the device will cause serious adverse health consequences or death.                                             | Notify regulatory bodies (FDA/ NCAs) within 24 to 48 hours.               |
| <b>Class II (Moderate Risk)</b> | A situation where use of or exposure to the device may cause temporary or medically reversible adverse health consequences, or where the probability of serious adverse health consequences is remote. | Notify regulatory bodies within 10 business days.                         |
| <b>Class III (Minor Issue)</b>  | A situation where use of or exposure to the device is not likely to cause adverse health consequences (e.g., cosmetic label errors, minor administrative paperwork mismatch).                          | Notify regulatory bodies via standard periodic updates or within 30 days. |

## 4.2 Immediate Logistical Quarantine and Distribution Containment

Once a field action is authorized by the FAEC, the Recall Coordinator must freeze all in-house, warehouse, and transit inventory of the affected part and lot sequences within the ERP platform. Logistics managers must physically move any stock found on production floors into secure, locked quarantine areas to prevent accidental shipping during containment activities.

**CRITICAL SAFETY MANDATE:** Distribution records must provide complete, immediate traceability from raw materials to final customer shipments. The Traceability Index must identify the exact facility address, lot number, serial sequence, shipping date, and carrier tracking identifier for every unit dispatched within 3 hours of FAEC mobilization.

## 4.3 Formulating Field Safety Notices (FSN) and Communication Blasts

The Recall Coordinator must compile a clear, urgent Field Safety Notice (FSN) to notify distributed accounts. The communication must be written in plain language, free of corporate boilerplate, and must include:

- Conspicuous headers indicating: "URGENT MEDICAL DEVICE RECALL - [Product Name]".
- Precise description of the product variants, lot numbers, and Unique Device Identification (UDI) sequences.
- Clear technical description of the underlying defect mode and associated patient clinical risks.
- Explicit, step-by-step instructions on how to locate, halt use, and isolate the hardware.
- A mandatory response card (Acknowledgment Form) that the customer must fill out and return within 5 business days to confirm receipt and verify current inventory status.

4.4 Product Retrieval, Storage, and Engineering Reconciliation

All physical returns sent from hospital sites must be logged into a dedicated field action repository zone upon receipt. The Recall Coordinator must maintain a live ledger to track reconciliation performance. This index calculates total units distributed against total units safely accounted for (units found in-house + customer inventory destroyed + hardware successfully returned). The system executes continuous distribution follow-up phone calls and letters until complete reconciliation milestones are achieved.

4.5 Effectiveness Audits and Root Cause Closure

The Recall Coordinator must conduct an effectiveness audit to verify that all customers received and understood the FSN. Once reconciliation targets are achieved, and a permanent solution has been implemented through the change control and CAPA systems, the FAEC compiles a final report for regulatory authorities. The file transitions to a "Closed" state only upon receiving written clearance from the respective national inspectorates.

6.0 Associated Reference Materials

- **SOP-QA-003:** Complaint Handling and Post-Market Intake
- **SOP-RA-005:** Medical Device Vigilance and Adverse Event Reporting [cite: 9]
- **SOP-QA-006:** Corrective and Preventive Action (CAPA) System
- **Form-QA-013A:** Health Hazard Assessment (HHA) Protocol Sheet

7.0 Revision History Log

| Revision Level | Effective Date | Author / Originator     | Detailed Description of Modifications                                                                                   |
|----------------|----------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 00             | [Date]         | [Name], Quality Systems | Initial baseline release of formalized Product Recall and Field Safety Corrective Actions Standard Operating Procedure. |